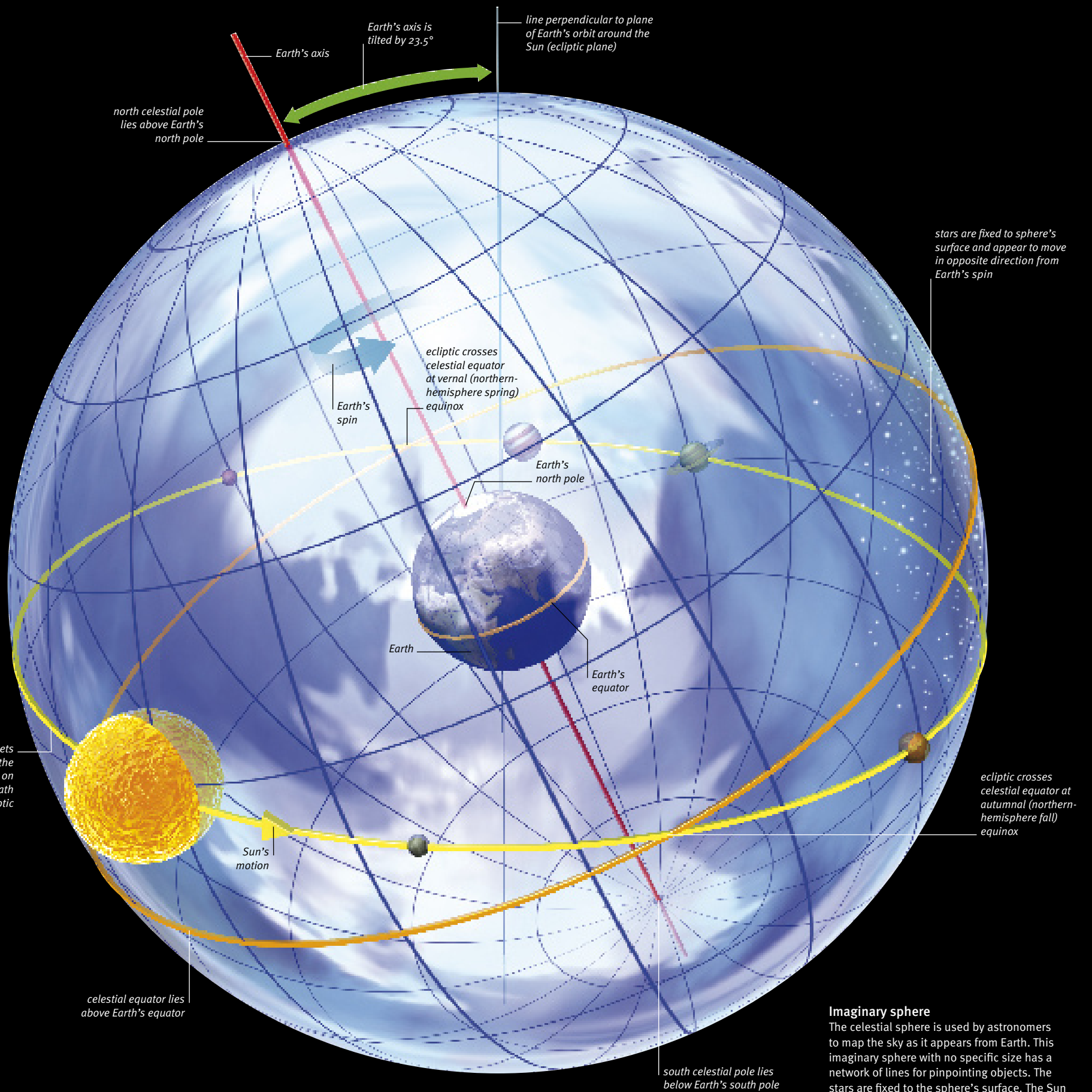




Imaginary sphere

The celestial sphere is used by astronomers to map the sky as it appears from Earth. This imaginary sphere with no specific size has a network of lines for pinpointing objects. The stars are fixed to the sphere's surface. The Sun and planets move around the sphere, on or close to a circular path, known as the ecliptic.